Test Plans

Test Plan for Sprint 1

Table 1- test plan sprint one

Test ID	Test description	steps	Expected results	Actual results	Status
Test 01	Verify students can enter their details and accept the terms and conditions.	Enter valid name, email, password. Click register. Check the terms and conditions before signing up.	An account is created on the system.	As expected	Passed
Test 02	Verify validation for empty fields.	Leave required fields blank. Click Create Account.	Validation error message appears.	As expected	Passed
Test 03	Invalid password validation.	Enter invalid password Click Create Account.	Registration fails and an error message is displayed.	As expected	Passed
Test 04	Verify login with user credentials.	Enter registered email and password. Click Access student portal.	User is redirected to the dashboard.	As expected	Passed
Test 05	Verify login fails with incorrect password.	Enter correct email. Enter wrong password. Click Access student portal.	Error message is displayed.	As expected	Passed
Test 06	Verify login fails with unregistered email.	Enter unregistered email. Click Access student portal.	Error message is displayed.	As expected	Passed
Test 07	Verify session is created after login.	Login successfully. Refresh page.	User remains logged in.	As expected	Passed

Test 08	Verify admins can access user management.	Login as admin. Open admin dashboard.	User management panel is visible.	As expected	Passed
Test 09	Verify admin can assign roles.	Select user. Assign role to that specific user. Save role.	Role updates saved successfully.	As expected	Passed
Test 10	Verify role-based access restriction.	Login as a student. Attempt admin access.	Access denied message appears.	As expected	Passed
Test 11	Verify admin can add academic year.	Login as admin. Add new academic year. Save.	Academic year is created.	As expected	Passed
Test 12	Verify admin can activate and deactivate a year.	Select academic year. Click deactivate.	Status changed successfully.	As expected	Passed
Test 13	Verify admins can set submissions deadline.	Login as admin. Enter submission date and save.	Deadline is stored successfully.	As expected	Passed
Test 14	Verify submission blocked after deadline.	Set deadline to past date. Attempt submission.	Submission will be blocked with a message.	As expected	Passed

Test 15	Verify editing blocked after final closure date.	Set closure date to past. Attempt to edit.	Editing will be disabled with a message.	As expected	Passed
Test 16	Authorised user access for reports.	Login as coordinator or admin. View statistics.	Statistical reports are visible.	As expected	Passed
Test 17	Search by submission title.	Enter submission title in search bar. Click search button.	Submission titles that match the entered title appears	As expected	Passed
Test 18	Search by student name.	Enter student name in search bar. Click search button.	Submission names that match the entered student name appears	As expected	Passed

Test Plan for Sprint 2

Table 2- test plan sprint two

Test ID	**Test description**	**steps**	**Expected results**	**Actual results**	**Status**
Test 01	Upload valid document types (.doc/.docx).	Login as a student. Directed to dashboard after login. Upload a valid file to submit in the submission page. Click submit.	The file is submitted successfully and appears in the submissions list.	As expected	Passed

Test 02	Upload valid JPG image.	Login as a student. Directed to dashboard after login. Upload a valid file to submit in the submission page. Click “add image” button. Select a JPG image from the device. Click “submit” button.	Image upload is successful and linked to the submission.	As expected	Passed
Test 03	Edit before deadline.	Login as a student. Go to my submissions page. Select an existing submission. Click edit. Replace the article or image accordingly. Click save changes.	Submission updated successfully and changes are reflected immediately.	As expected	Passed
Test 04	Attempt to edit after final closure date.	Login as a student. Go to my submissions page. Click edit on an existing submission.	System blocks the icon for editing and deleting.	As expected	Passed
Test 05	View submission status.	Login as a student. Go to my submissions page. View a list of submissions. Check the status of the submission on each submission card.	Current status (draft/pending/ commented/ selected/rejected) is displayed correctly.	As expected	Passed

Test 06	Comment within 14 days.	Login as a marketing coordinator. Directed to marketing coordinators dashboard. Select a submission. Enter feedback in the comment section. Click submit comment button.	Comment is saved and visible to the student.	As expected	Passed
Test 07	Select submissions.	Login as a marketing coordinator. Directed to marketing coordinators dashboard. Open a student submission and review. Select selected from the drop down. Click the update status button.	Status updates are selected and reflected on the student's dashboard in real-time.	As expected	Passed
Test 08	Email notification.	Login as a student. Upload article successfully. Submit article.	Email notification received containing student name, title, faculty, and submission date.	As expected	Passed

Test Plan for Sprint 3

Table 3- test plan sprint three

Test ID	**Test Description**	**Steps**	**Expected results**	**Actual Results**	**Status**

Test 01	Student view coordinator comments.	Student login to the system. Navigate to my submissions. Select a submitted article. Scroll to comments section and view comments.	Comments appear under the selected submission with date and time.	As expected	Passed
Test 02	Student reply to coordinator comment.	Student login to the system. Navigate to my submissions. Select a submitted article. View coordinator comments. Enter a reply and click reply.	Reply is saved and displayed under the comment thread from coordinator.	As expected	Passed
Test 03	Student receive notification after coordinator comment.	Coordinator comments on submission. Students get email notifications.	Student receives notification about new comment.	As expected	Passed
Test 04	Manager views all selected contributions.	Marketing manager logs in. Opens manager dashboard. Navigate to submissions page. Apply filters (faculty/name).	All selected submissions are displayed with filters working.	As expected	Passed
Test 05	Zip downloads after closure date.	Manager logs in after final closure date. Navigate to selected contributions. Click download zip.	Zip download button will be visible and can be downloaded.	As expected	Passed

Test 06	Zip downloads not available before final closure date.	Manager logs in after final closure date. Navigate to selected contributions. Selects download zip button on the header.	An error message saying “Download is only available after the final closure date” appears.	As expected	Passed
Test 07	Guest views selected contributions.	Guest opens login in the home page on the system. Navigate to published contributions page. Browse available content.	Guest can view only selected submissions without login.	As expected	Passed
Test 08	View submissions without comments report.	Admin/coordinator/manager logs in. Open reports section. Select no comments report.	The system displays a list of submissions with no comments after 14 days.	As expected	Passed

Test plan screenshots
Sprint one test:

Test 1: Verify students can enter their details and accept the terms and conditions.

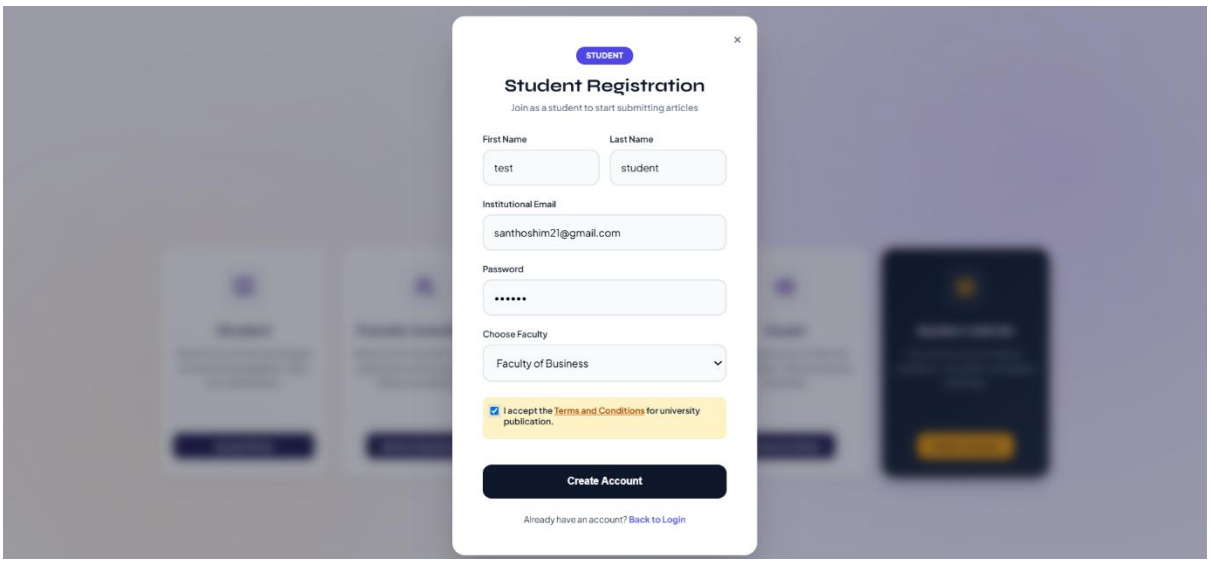


Figure 1- registration page student (test)

Figure 2- student dashboard direction (test)

The test one shows proof that it works as expected, allowing students to register in the system and directing them to student dashboard.

Test 3- Invalid password validation.

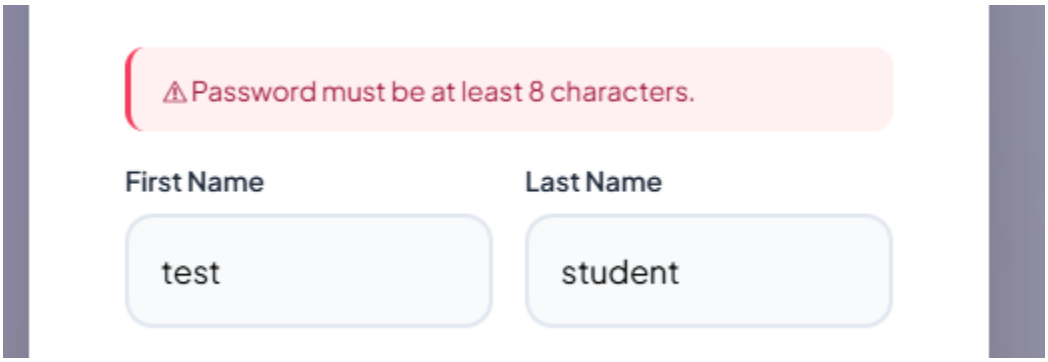


Figure 3- invalid password (test)

The test three works as expected, showing an error message to students when their entered password isn't at least 8 characters.

Test 5- Verify login fails with incorrect password.

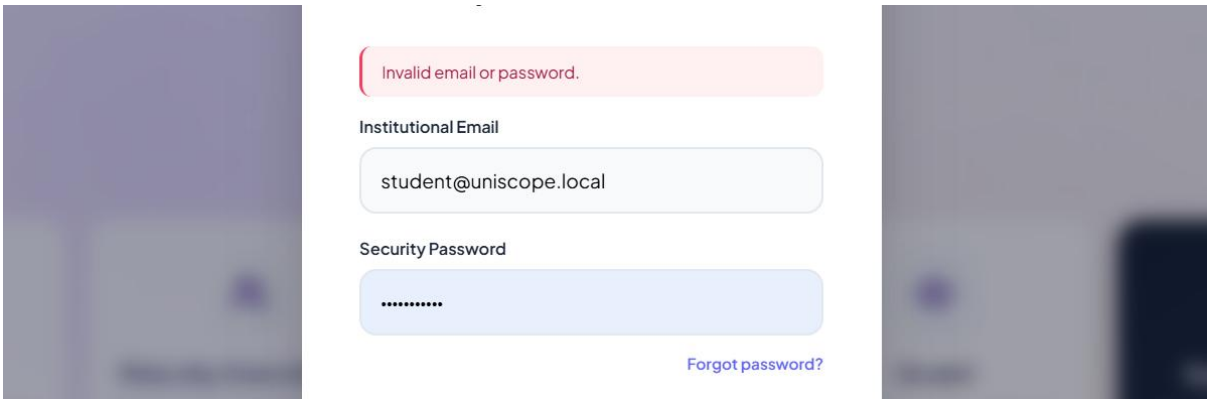


Figure 4- incorrect password (test)

Test 6- Verify login fails with unregistered email.

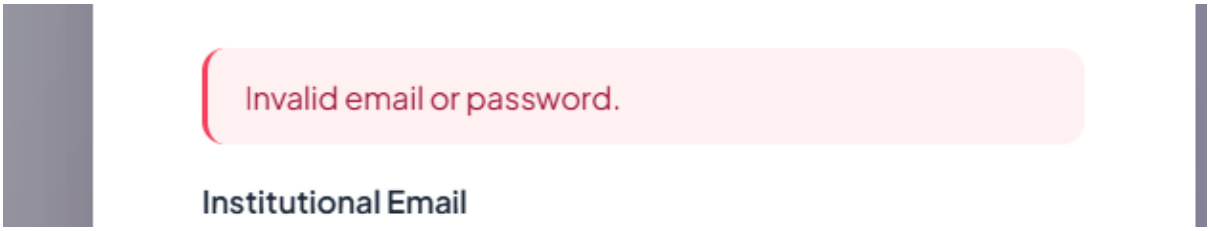


Figure 5- unregistered email (test)

Test 5 and 6 works as expected, showing users an error message when they enter invalid password or email.

Test 10- Verify role-based access restriction.

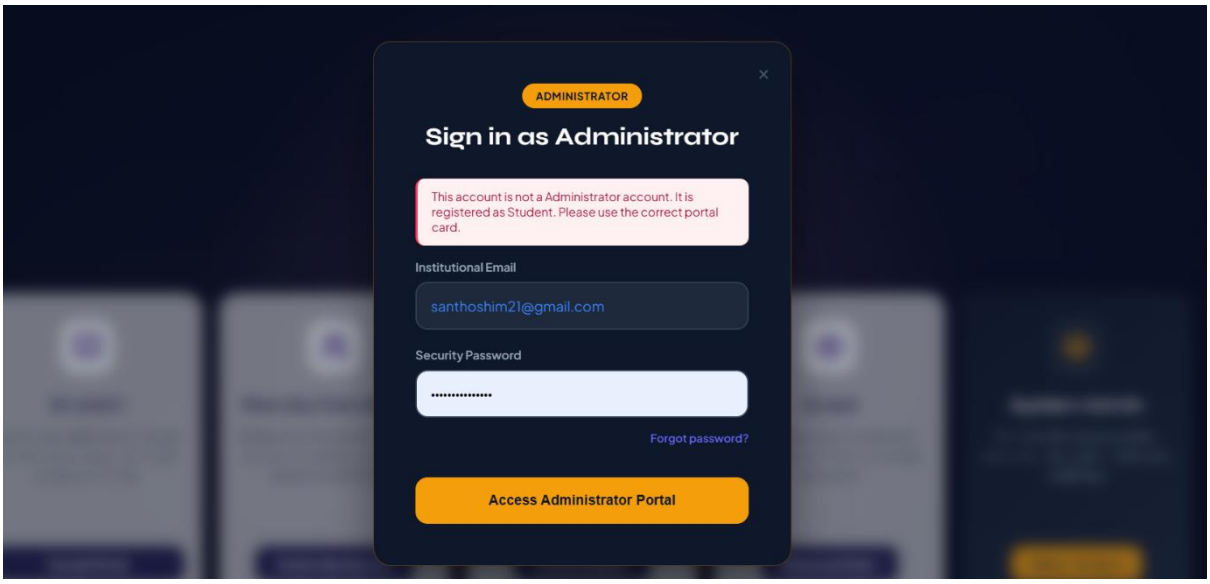


Figure 6- role based access (test)

The test 10 works as expected, restricting students from the admin side and displaying an error message.

Test 17- search by submission title

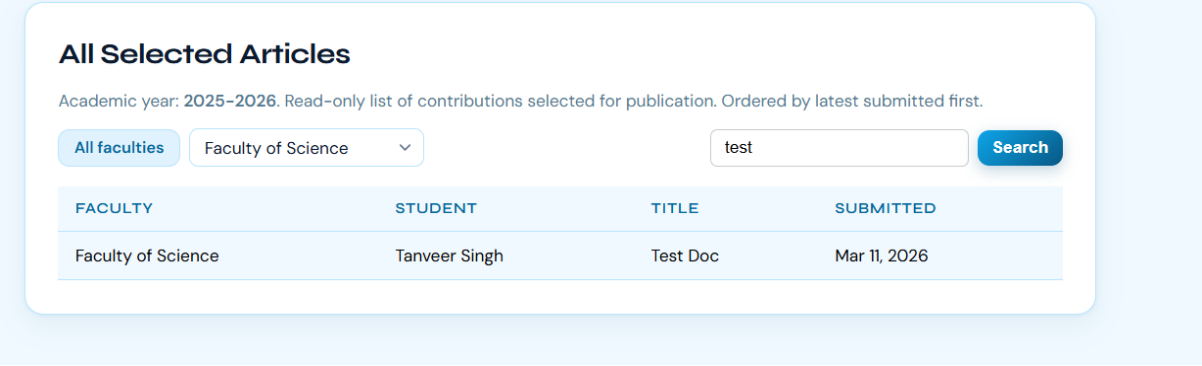


Figure 7- search functionality (test)

Test 17 works as expected, allowing authorised users to search for submissions by submission title.

Sprint two test:

Test 1- Upload valid document types (.doc/.docx).

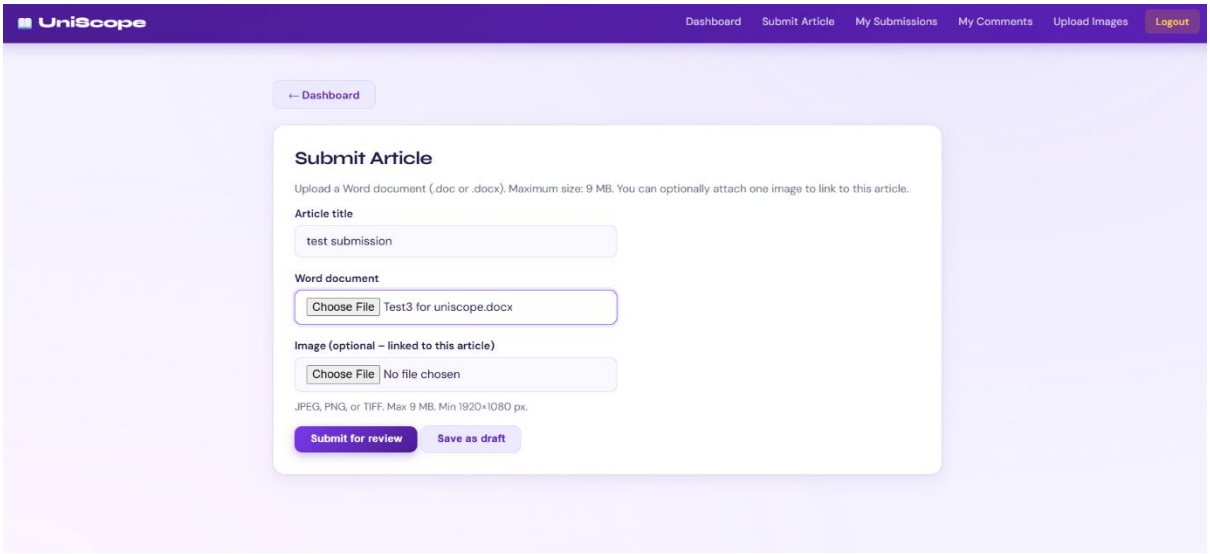


Figure 8- upload document

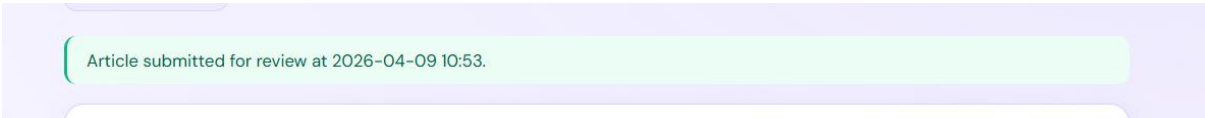


Figure 9- document uploaded message

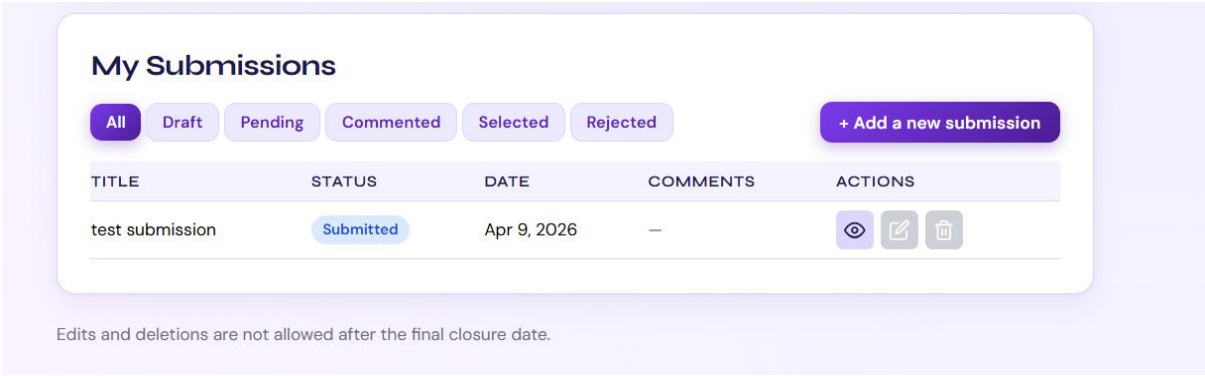


Figure 10- document added to my submissions

Test one works as expected, allowing users to upload a document and it reflects in my submissions in real-time.

Test 2- Upload valid JPG image.

Figure 11- upload valid image

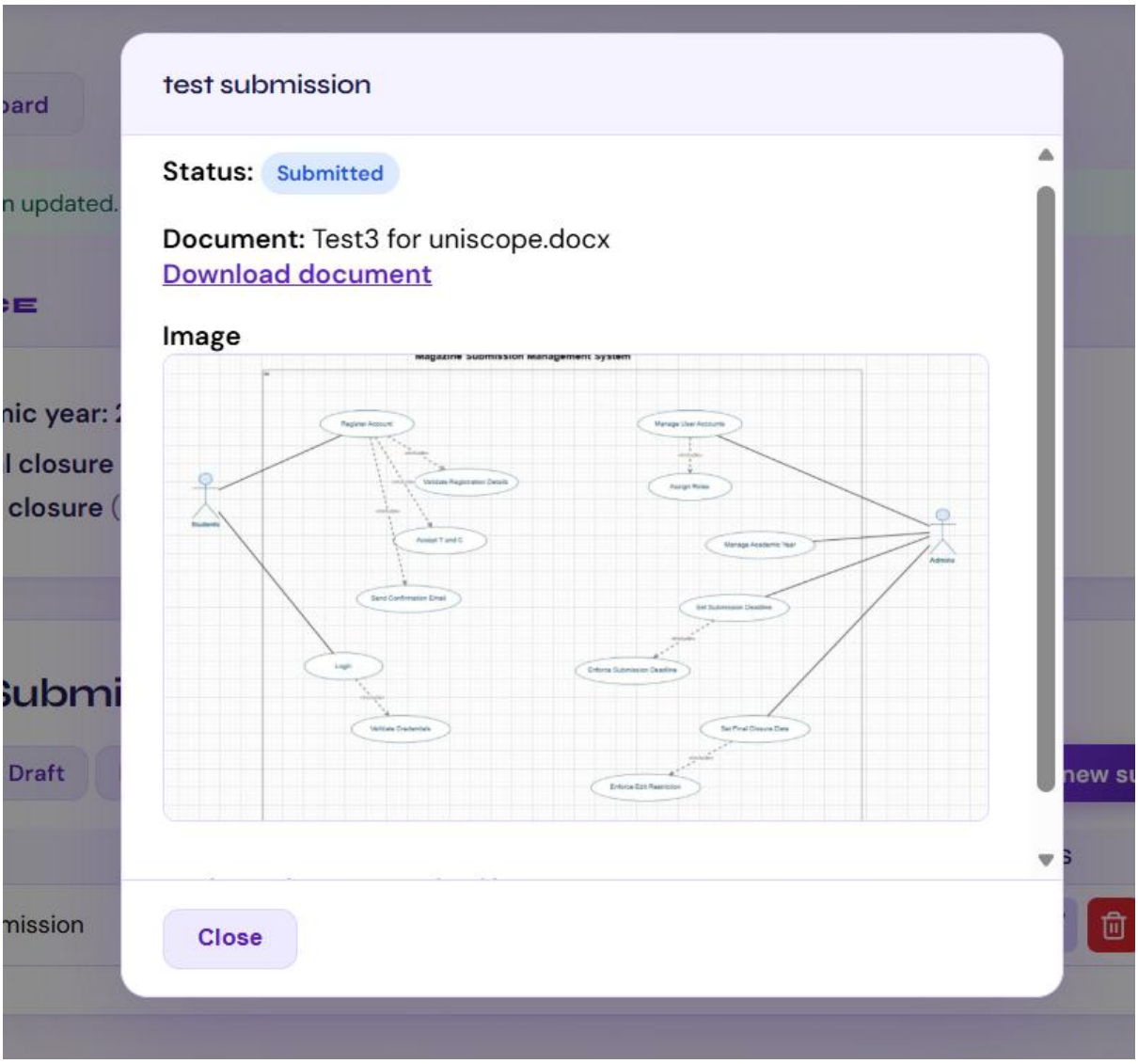


Figure 12- image linked to submission

The test two works as expected, allowing users to add an image to the submission and links to the document.

Test 4- Attempt to edit after final closure date.

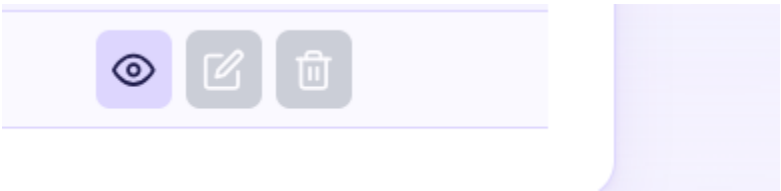


Figure 13- edit after final closure blocked

Test four works as expected, which blocks the edit and deletes icon in students' side after final closure date.

Test 8- Email notification.

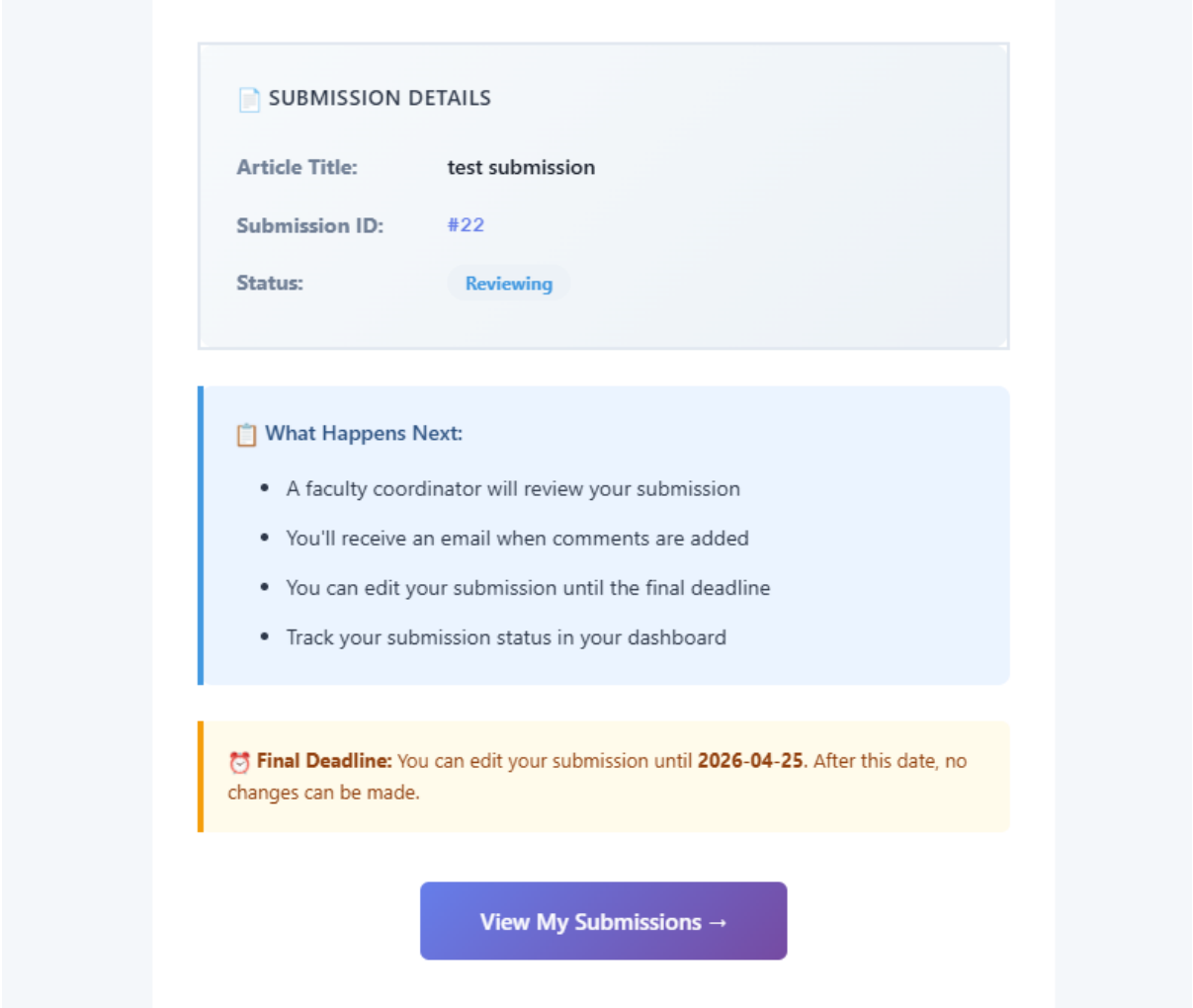


Figure 14- email notification for coordinator feedback to students

Test eight works as expected, the system sends an email to student about the coordinator feedback.

Sprint three test:

Test 4- Manager views all selected contributions.

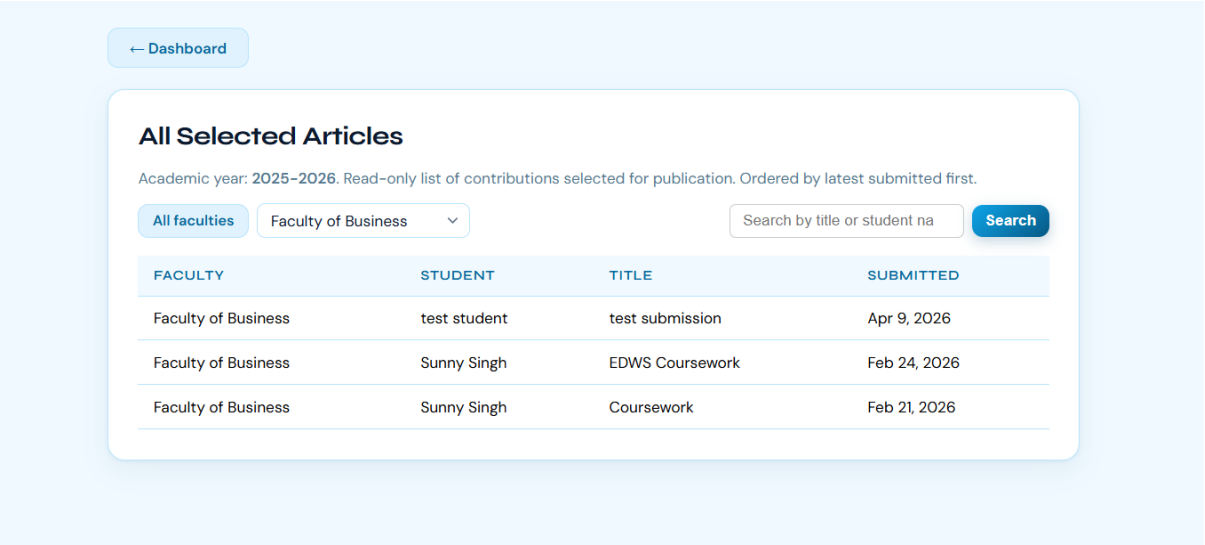


Figure 15- manager views selected contributions

Test four works as expected, allowing managers to view all selected articles for the magazine.

Test 6- Zip downloads not available before final closure date.

Figure 16- zip downloads not available before final closure date

Test six works as expected, which wouldn't allow managers to download zip before final closure date and shows an error message.

Test 8- View submissions without comments report.

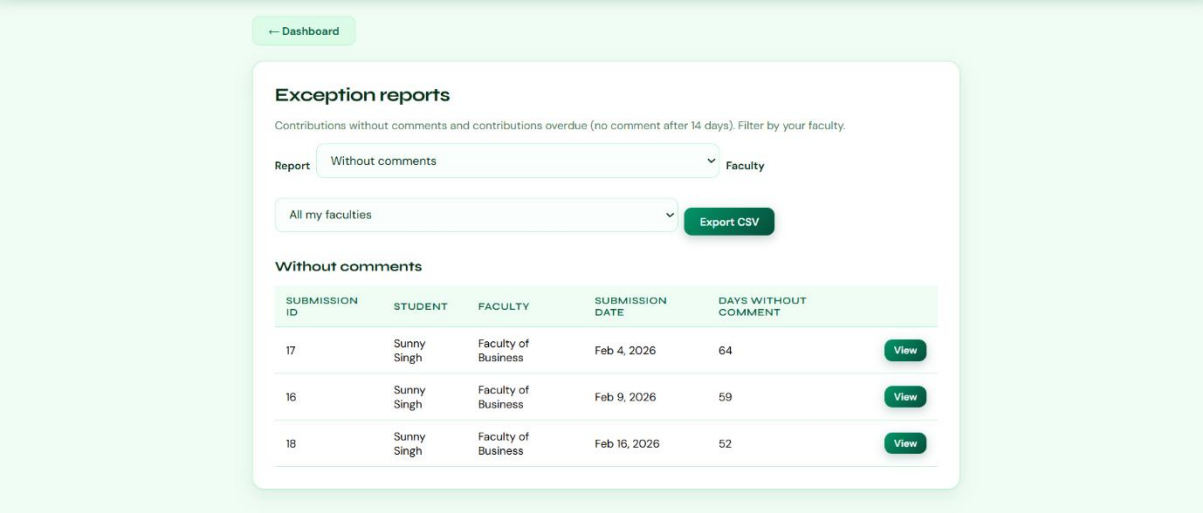


Figure 17- exception reports

The test eight works as expected, which will allow authorised users to view the exception reports with no comments after 14-days.

Errors Encountered and Fixes in Test: During the development process, several technical issues were identified and resolved. Below are three specific errors that were encountered and fixed, with before and after evidence.

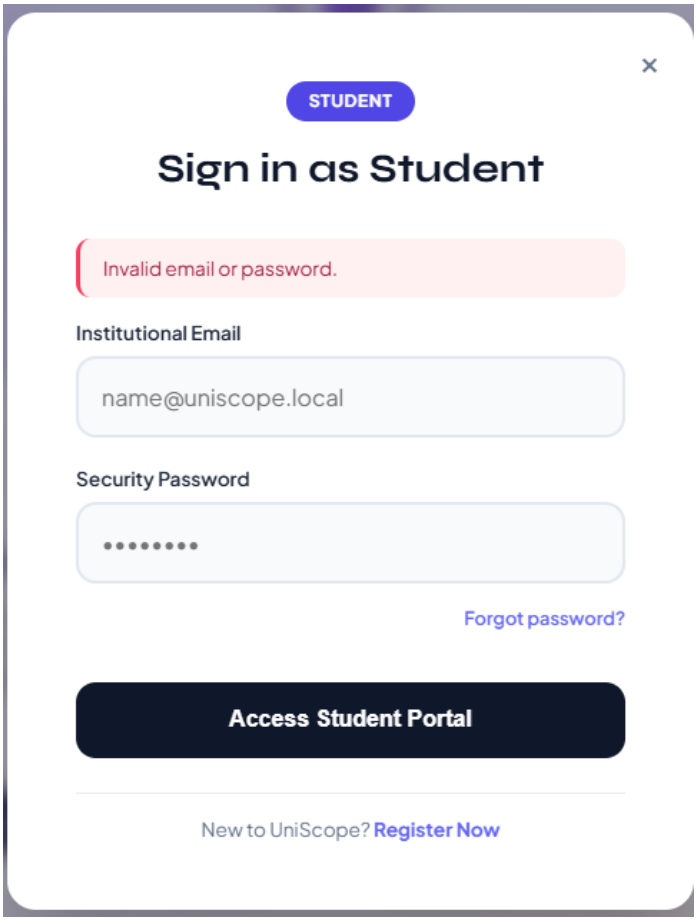
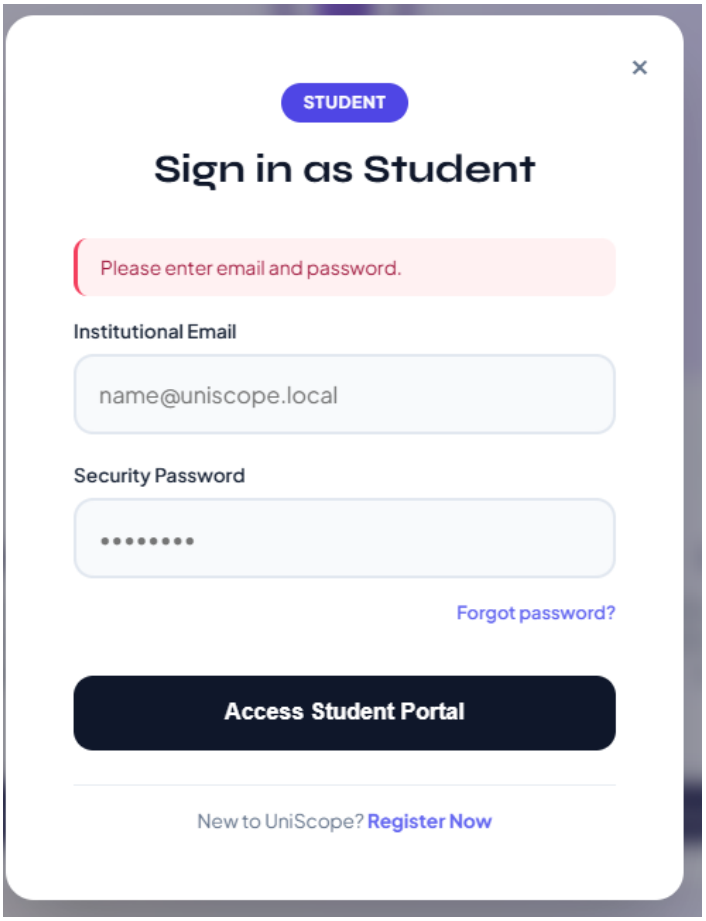
1. **Error 1: Login Validation for Empty Fields**

Error Description: The login system originally lacked specific validation for empty inputs. This allowed users to submit the form without entering any credentials. Technically, this was inefficient as it forced the server to perform database lookups for empty strings. For the user, it was confusing because the system would either show a generic "Invalid credentials" message or simply fail without explaining that fields were missing.

How It Was Fixed:

Client-Side: Added the required attribute to the HTML input fields in login.php. This triggers the browser's built-in validation to stop submission if fields are empty.

Server-Side: Added a PHP check if ($email === '' || $password === '') before any database queries are made. If fields are empty, the system now specifically returns the message: "Please enter email and password."

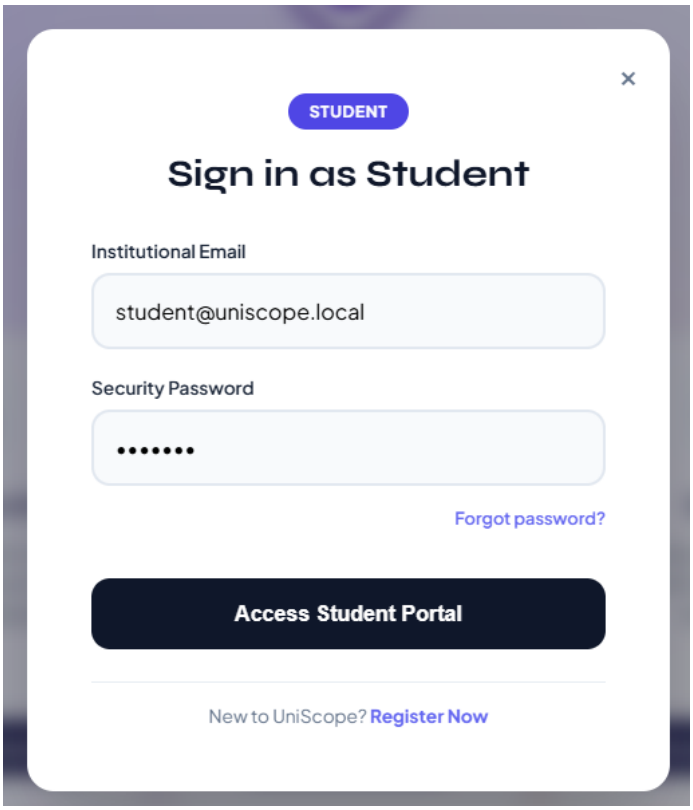
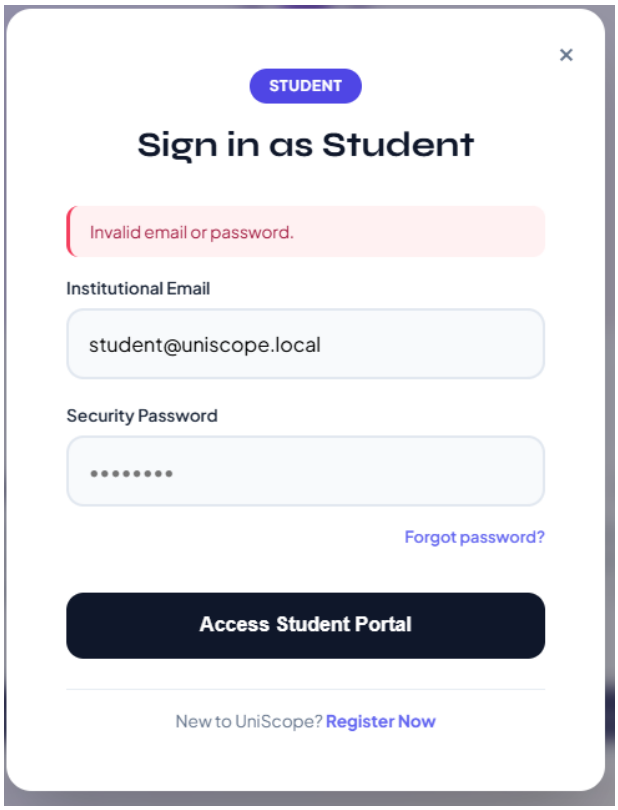
Before (No error message for empty fields)	After (Clear error message shown)
	

2. **Error 2: Wrong Password Error – No Visual Feedback**

Error Description: The system failed to provide visual feedback when an authentication attempt failed due to an incorrect password. While the backend correctly processed the failure and prevented access, it did not communicate this to the user. This resulted in the page simply reloading without explanation, which could lead users to believe the "Login" button was broken or that a server-side crash had occurred.

How It Was Fixed: The error handling logic in the authentication block was restored. We ensured that when the password_verify() check fails, a specific error message ("Invalid email or password")

is assigned to the $loginError variable. This variable is then rendered in the login modal's error alert box, providing the user with immediate and clear feedback on the failure.

Before (No error message shown)	**After (Clear "Invalid email or password" message)**
	

3. Error 2: Wrong Password Error – No Visual Feedback

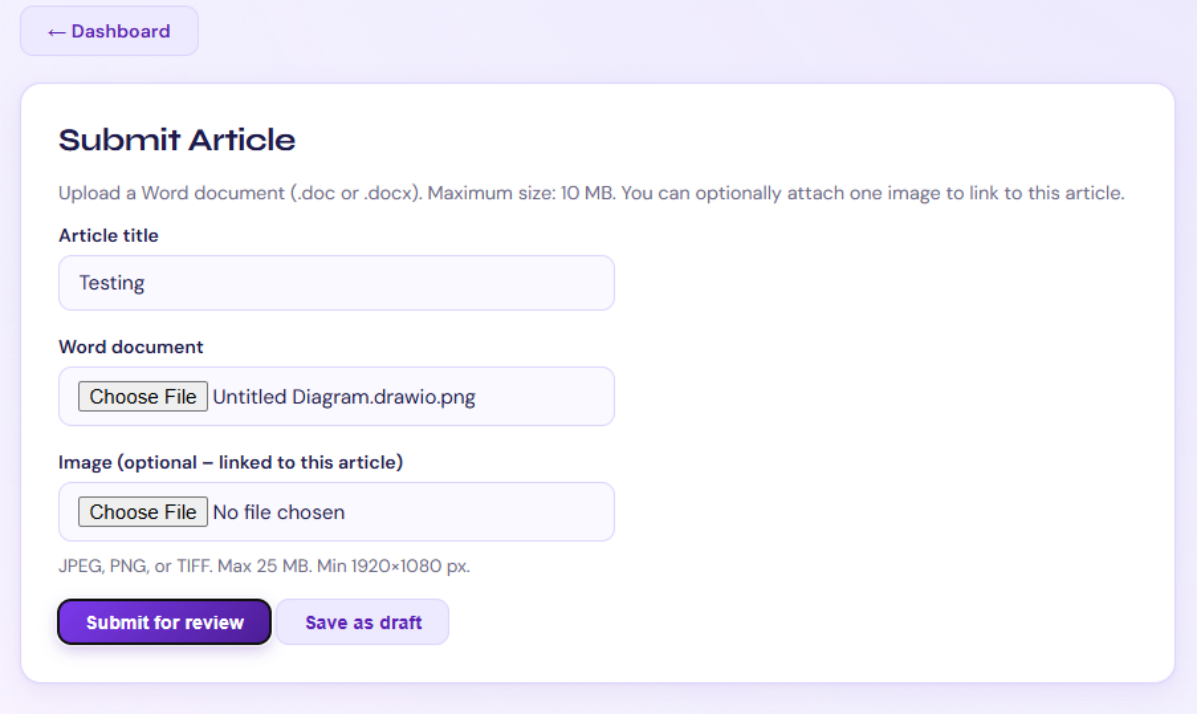
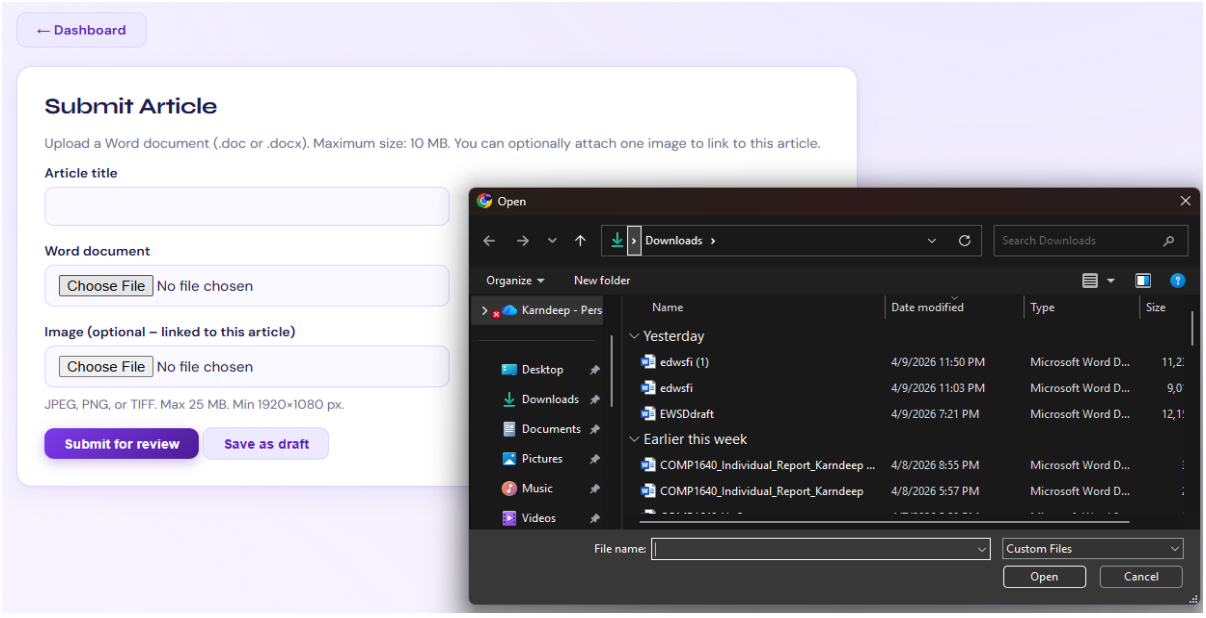
Error Description: The system initially allowed the upload of any file type into the "Article" slot and lacked a mechanism to enforce file size limits. This was a major issue because it allowed users to upload non-document files (like JPGs or PDFs) as articles, which corrupted the database integrity. Furthermore, the lack of size restrictions meant that extremely large files could be uploaded, potentially overwhelming the server's storage and bandwidth.

How It Was Fixed:

Dual-Layer Validation: We implemented both client-side and server-side checks. On the frontend, the accept attribute was added to the file inputs to filter out invalid file types during

selection. On the backend, PHP logic was added to verify both the file extension and the MIME type (the actual file content) to ensure only valid Word documents are accepted.

Size Limits: A PHP conditional check was added to compare the uploaded file size against a configurable maximum (10MB). If the file is too large, the system now rejects it and displays a clear message: "File is too large. Maximum 10 MB.

Before (Invalid file types accepted)	

After (Only .doc/.docx files allowed, size limit enforced)